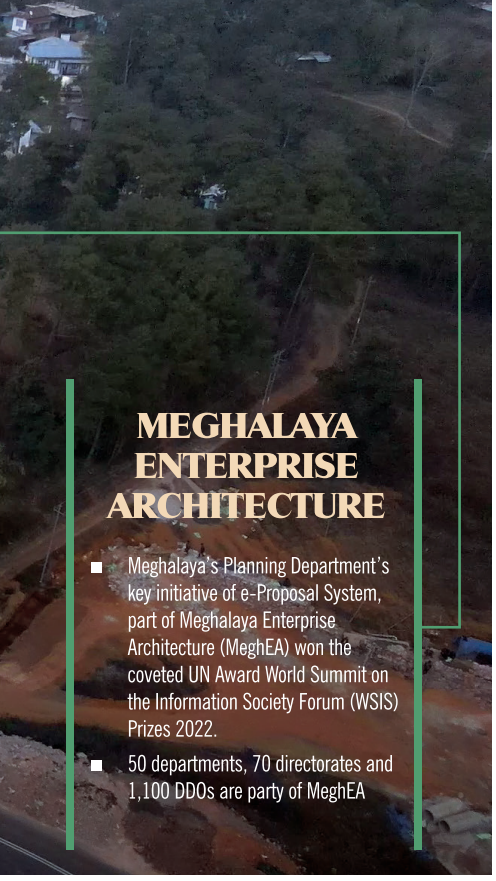


MEGHALAYA ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE

- Meghalaya's Planning Department's key initiative of e-Proposal System, part of Meghalaya Enterprise Architecture (MeghEA) won the coveted UN Award World Summit on the Information Society Forum (WSIS) Prizes 2022.
- 50 departments, 70 directorates and 1,100 DDOs are party of MeghEA



financial assistance up to Rs 1 lakh to registered youth clubs and organisations across the state to carry out developmental activities relating to any of these focused areas—environmental protection and conservation programmes and workshops, financial literacy workshops and campaigns, substance abuse, teenage pregnancies awareness dissemination workshops and seminars, career counselling and guidance workshops and clinics, mass youth engagement programmes and activities, mental wellbeing seminars and campaigns, mass youth volunteering programmes, organisation of youth parliaments and debates, procurement of material, equipment and setting up of office space.

There are more than 3,000 registered youth clubs and organisations across the State who are working in different sectors. Apart from this, the government has instituted scholarship awards amounted One Crore for sporting talents. Moreover 238 athletes who achieved medals in North-East Olympic Games were rewarded with cash award of Rs. 37 Lakhs. "We are working on promoting entrepreneurship as we are aware that 50,000 youths are entering the market every year," says Conrad Sangma.

The state now also has an IT Park—Shillong Technology Park—which was inaugurated in February 2022. Spread over 80 acres of land currently, the first phase building of the technology park is going to create employment for more than 1,500 people directly and nearly three times job opportunities indirectly. "Meghalaya has 70 per cent population below the age of 35 years. The state has tremendous potential in IT sector. We have a great demographic dividend to harness the young people in the technology sector. Making the youth future ready at mass level is the prime focus of the government," says Conrad Sangma. Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid foundation stone for the second phase of the Shillong IT Park. This will create another 3,000 jobs. Another world class infrastructure is PA Sangma Integrated Sports Complex in Tura. Coming at a cost of Rs 128 crore and equipped to host national and international tournaments, the complex has a sitting capacity of 10,000.

Efforts were made to decentralise the power structure so that people could participate in the process of development at the grassroots level. The change is visible across all categories—infrastructure development, healthcare, education, power generation, job creation, women empowerment, prosperity of farmers, skill development, youth and child welfare, connectivity, tourism, and hospitality.

The connectivity in the state has improved considerably in last four years. There was a time when there was no flight from Shillong. Today the state has a functional airport servicing more than 10,000 passengers every month since 2021. The government has procured 800 acres of land in New Shillong Township to decongest the old city by setting up a new administrative city there.

Close to 3.5 lakh women are part of 38,000 self-help groups, a big jump of over 1,000 per cent from just 30,000 women in self-help groups in 2018. The government providing direct piped water to over 2.75 lakh households in about four years as compared to only 4,000 such families in 2019. This has improved and touched the lives of about 12 lakh individuals in the state through the Jal Jeevan Mission.

The decisive leadership of the chief minister left a mark in every domain. This year is estimated to be more than Rs.18,000 Crore. This has been possible because of tapping of external agencies, timely implementation of projects and running Central schemes in an efficient manner. Meghalaya has mobilised nearly Rs 10,000 crore from external agencies, a big jump from Rs 2,500 crore in 2018. Funds from these agencies support projects in tourism, water catchment area, road construction, integrated transport system and early childhood development programme among others.

Following the historic 2019 judgement by Supreme Court upholding the rights of tribal people over the land and minerals, mining has once again resumed in the state, bringing back livelihood opportunities to many in Meghalaya. The state government is taking all possible measures to encourage and ensure scientific mining.

The good news did not end there. Sangma genuinely believes that there is a huge potential for international trade between Meghalaya and neighbouring country Bangladesh. As a leader who steers clear of rhetoric and believe in walking the talk, he became the first Meghalaya chief minister to visit Jaintapur, an ancient kingdom, now a sub-division in Bangladesh. During his four-day-long tour to Bangladesh in 2019, Conrad has proposed to Government of India to build a new road from Mahendarganj in Garo Hills to Hili in West Bengal, passing through Bangladesh. This road would reduce the distance of travel from 1,100 km to 600 km thereby easing logistics movement.

While Conrad Sangma-led Meghalaya Democratic Alliance has nearly completed its term, the chief minister has no time to celebrate and pause. The road not build, and the state is burdened with a legacy of historical underperformance and political mismanagement. That makes the accomplishments of the first tenure of Conrad Sangma government even more significant.

But the chief minister is in no mood to claim credit yet. He sees this spike in the developmental curve of the state as a collective achievement of the people of Meghalaya. "I want to thank all our citizens for their support and contributions in building Meghalaya. I feel proud to be leading this amazing journey of building Meghalaya as a vibrant, caring, robust economy and society," he says.